

Voluntary Report – Voluntary - Public Distribution

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Report Name: Strong 2025 Southwest Monsoon Boosts Water Availability

Country: India

Post: Mumbai

Report Category: Agricultural Situation, Cotton and Products, Grain and Feed, Oilseeds and Products, Agriculture in the News

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Report Highlights:

The 2025 southwest monsoon featured an early onset, overall surplus rainfall, and notable regional disparities, with deficits in the east and northeast but surpluses in central India. The season ended slightly late on October 16, with a particularly wet September highlighting increasing rainfall variability. India received 937.2 millimeters (mm) of rainfall during the southwest monsoon season (June 1 to September 30), surpassing the normal of 868.6 mm by eight percent. Kharif (monsoon) sowing rose by one percent, led by gains in rice, maize, and sugarcane, while oilseeds, cotton, and pulses declined. Reservoir storage remained strong at over 91 percent of capacity, ensuring good water availability for the upcoming rabi (winter) season.

DISCLAIMER: The information contained in this report was retrieved from the Ministry of Earth Sciences/Indian Meteorological Department's (IMD) website <https://mausam.imd.gov.in/>. The U.S. Consulate General Mumbai – Foreign Agricultural Service (FAS) Office of Agricultural Affairs (OAA), USDA and/or the U.S. government make no claim of accuracy or authenticity. The Government of India has not officially endorsed this report.

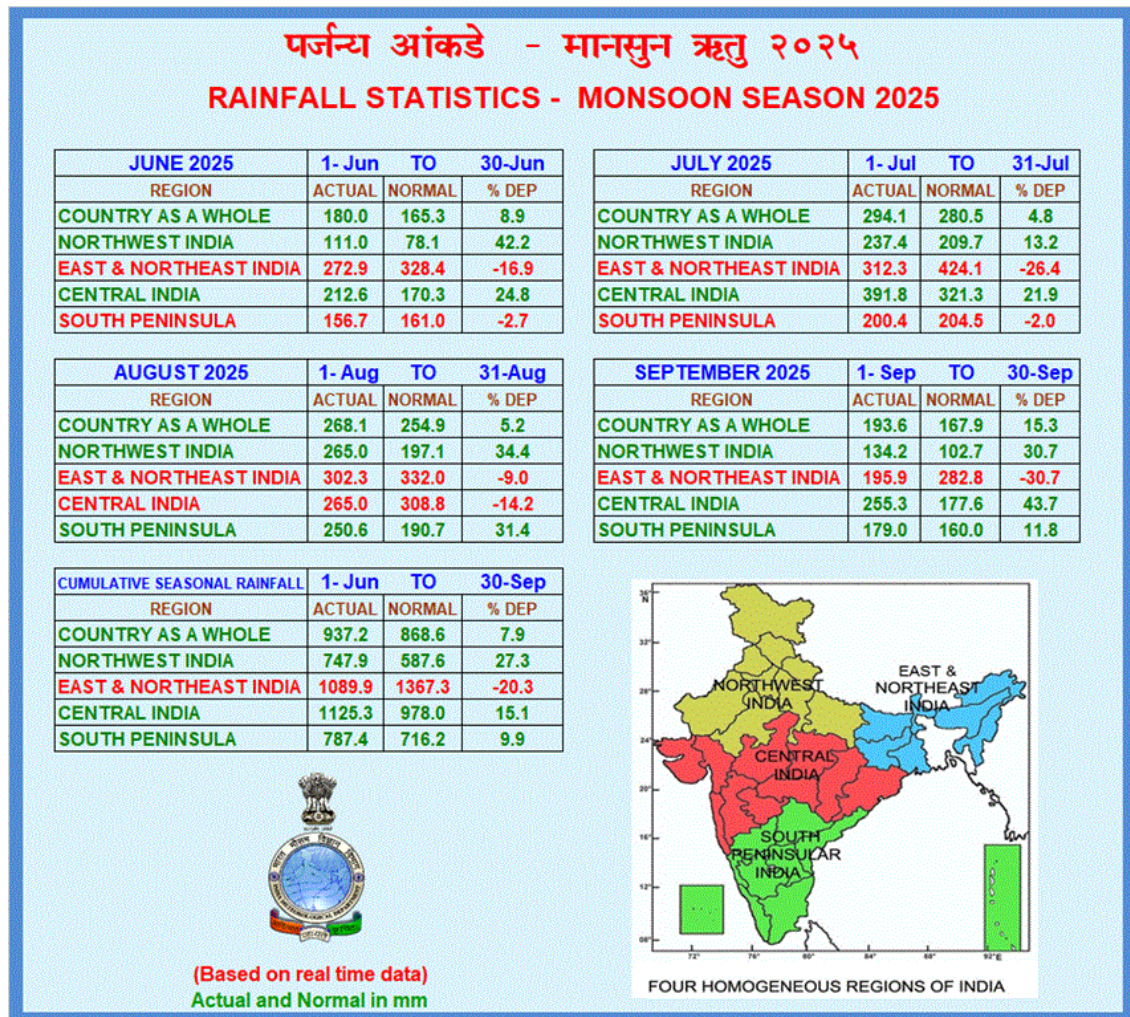
Regional and Temporal Variations in India's Monsoon Rainfall Patterns

The monsoon reached Kerala on May 24, marking its earliest onset over the Indian mainland since 2009. All four monsoon months (June to September) recorded above-average rainfall. The southwest monsoon covered the entire country by June 29.

Regional and temporal disparities in rainfall across India during the season reveal a complex monsoon pattern marked by uneven distribution and variability. The east and northeast regions received 1,089.9 mm of rainfall, which was 20 percent below the normal of 1,367.3 mm, signaling a significant deficit that may have negatively impacted rain-fed agriculture and groundwater recharge. On the other hand, central India got about 18 percent more rain than normal because the monsoon was in a favorable position and several weather systems brought extra rain to the area. Meanwhile, south India and northwest India recorded near-normal rainfall, with six percent and negative two percent deviations, respectively, suggesting relatively stable conditions compared to the more volatile patterns elsewhere.

An analysis of monthly rainfall distribution further illustrates the intra-seasonal variability of the monsoon. June recorded 109 percent of the long-period average (LPA), reflecting a strong onset of the monsoon. This was followed by July and August, both at 105 percent of the LPA, indicating a consistently active phase during the core monsoon months. September, however, saw a significant increase to 116 percent of the LPA, suggesting an extended and vigorous withdrawal phase. This pattern points to a delayed retreat and potentially prolonged moisture availability in several regions. Overall, the regional and monthly variations indicate a surplus of water available for groundwater recharge and irrigation, enhancing the crop outlook for the upcoming *rabi* season.

Figure 1: Rainfall Statistics for Southwest Monsoon 2025

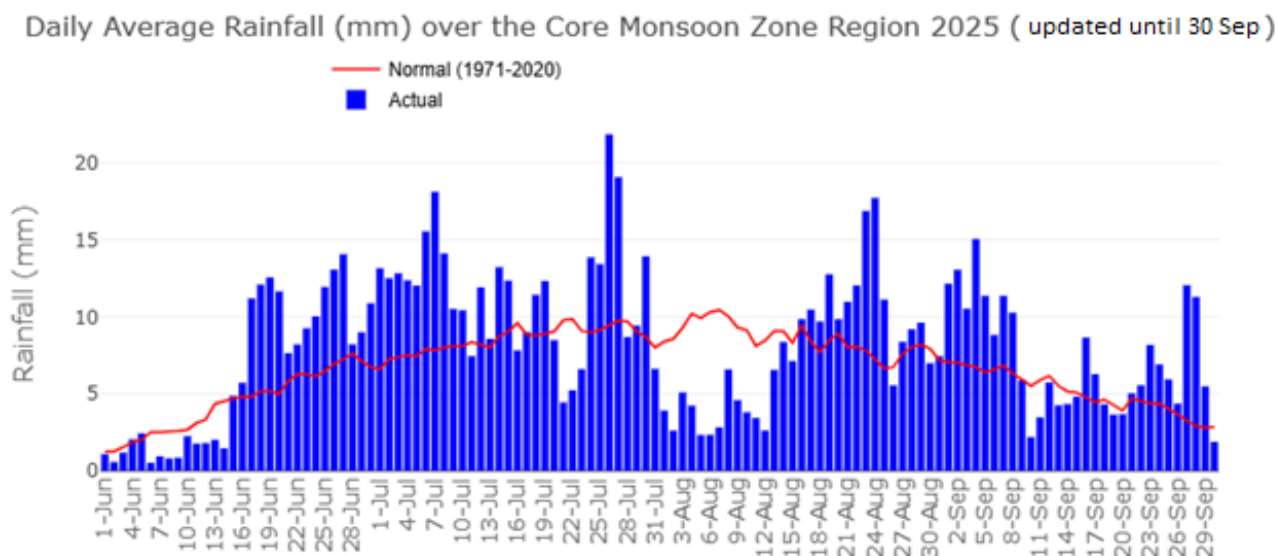


Source: Indian Meteorological Department

Heavy Rains Disrupt Harvests, Farmers Gear Up for *Rabi* Season

The southwest monsoon [withdrew](#) from India on October 16, while the northeast monsoon began over parts of southern India. Despite this, heavy rains and thunderstorms are expected in the south due to cyclonic activity, with [rainfall](#) 20 percent above normal (Oct 1–22). This may delay the harvesting of paddy, millets, and cotton, and affect samba rice transplanting. Farmers are advised to store harvested crops safely and ensure drainage in crop fields and plantations to prevent waterlogging, especially in Tamil Nadu, Kerala, Karnataka, coastal and southwest Andhra Pradesh, and Rayalaseema. In drier regions, farmers are preparing for *rabi* sowing of crops like sorghum, chickpea, and wheat. In central India (Maharashtra, Gujarat), harvesting of mature crops and *rabi* sowing is ongoing. In the north, harvesting of paddy, maize, and pulses continues alongside sowing of rapeseed, mustard, chickpea, and vegetables, particularly in Punjab and Haryana.

Figure 2. Average Rainfall over Core Monsoon Zone Region



Source: Climate Research & Services, India Meteorological Department

Stable Sowing Supported by Rice and Maize Gains, but Oilseeds and Cotton Lag

India's *Kharif* sowing in 2025 showed a one percent year-on-year (YoY) increase and stood two percent above the five-year average, reflecting overall stability supported by favorable monsoon conditions. Rice and maize led to gains, with areas sown rising by one percent and 13 percent YoY, respectively, while coarse cereals also expanded six percent, highlighting a shift toward resilient, high-yield crops. In contrast, oilseeds saw a five percent decline, mainly due to reduced soybean and groundnut acreage, and cotton fell three percent YoY, remaining 15 percent below normal amid market and pest challenges. Pulses showed only marginal improvement (one percent YoY, seven percent below normal), with uneven trends across varieties. Sugarcane continued to expand (three percent YoY, 12 percent above normal), supported by strong irrigation. Overall, the 2025 season reflects stable agricultural performance, with cereal and sugarcane gains offsetting declines in oilseeds and fiber crops.

Table 1. Kharif 2025 Crop Sowing Progress (in million hectares)

Crop	Area Sown as of October 3, 2025	Area Sown as of October 3, 2024	Normal Area (Five-year Average)	Y-o-Y Change	Change from Normal	Absolute Change
Rice	44.158	43.568	40.309	1%	10%	0.59
Pulses	12.042	11.905	12.961	1%	-7%	0.14
<i>Arhar (Tur/Pigeonpea)</i>	4.660	4.645	4.471	0%	4%	0.02
<i>Urdbean (Blackgram)</i>	2.437	2.287	3.264	7%	-25%	0.15
<i>Moongbean</i>	3.487	3.496	3.569	0%	-2%	-0.01
<i>Kulthi (Horsegram)</i>	0.072	0.056	0.172	29%	-58%	0.02
<i>Mothbean</i>	0.924	0.963	0.970	-4%	-5%	-0.04
<i>Other Pulses*</i>	0.462	0.458	0.515	1%	-10%	0.00
Coarse Cereals	19.466	18.354	18.071	6%	8%	1.11
<i>Jowar</i>	1.407	1.421	1.507	-1%	-7%	-0.01
<i>Bajra</i>	6.844	6.865	7.069	0%	-3%	-0.02
<i>Ragi</i>	1.181	1.196	1.152	-1%	3%	-0.01
<i>Small millets</i>	0.539	0.442	0.448	22%	20%	0.10
<i>Maize</i>	9.495	8.430	7.895	13%	20%	1.07
Oilseeds	19.013	20.076	19.463	-5%	-2%	-1.06
<i>Groundnut</i>	4.836	4.996	4.510	-3%	7%	-0.16
<i>Soybean</i>	12.045	12.955	12.719	-7%	-5%	-0.91
<i>Sunflower</i>	0.071	0.073	0.129	-3%	-45%	0.00
<i>Sesamum</i>	1.051	1.107	1.032	-5%	2%	-0.06
<i>Niger</i>	0.104	0.098	0.108	6%	-4%	0.01
<i>Castor</i>	0.898	0.839	0.965	7%	-7%	0.06
<i>Other Oilseeds</i>	0.008	0.008	0.000	0%	-	0.00
Sugarcane	5.907	5.722	5.251	3%	12%	0.19
Jute and Mesta	0.556	0.575	0.660	-3%	-16%	-0.02
Cotton	11.003	11.297	12.950	-3%	-15%	-0.29
Total	112.145	111.497	109.665	1%	2%	0.65

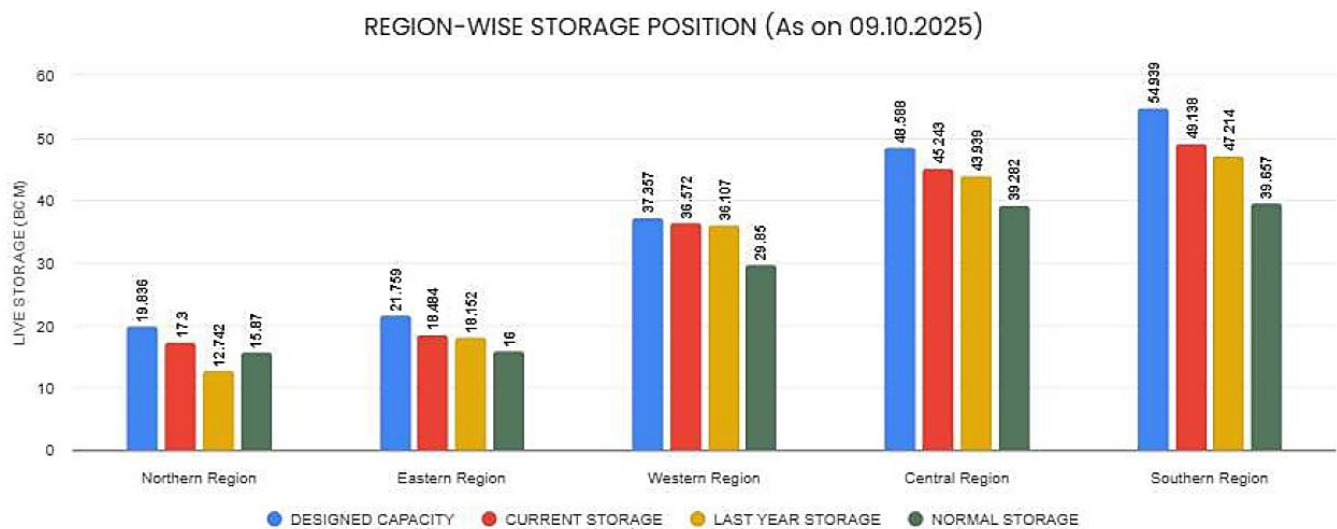
*Other Pulses – Kulthi and Mothbean

Source: [Crop situation report](#) as on October 6, 2025, Ministry of Agriculture and Farmers' Welfare

India Records Above-Normal Reservoir Storage in October 2025

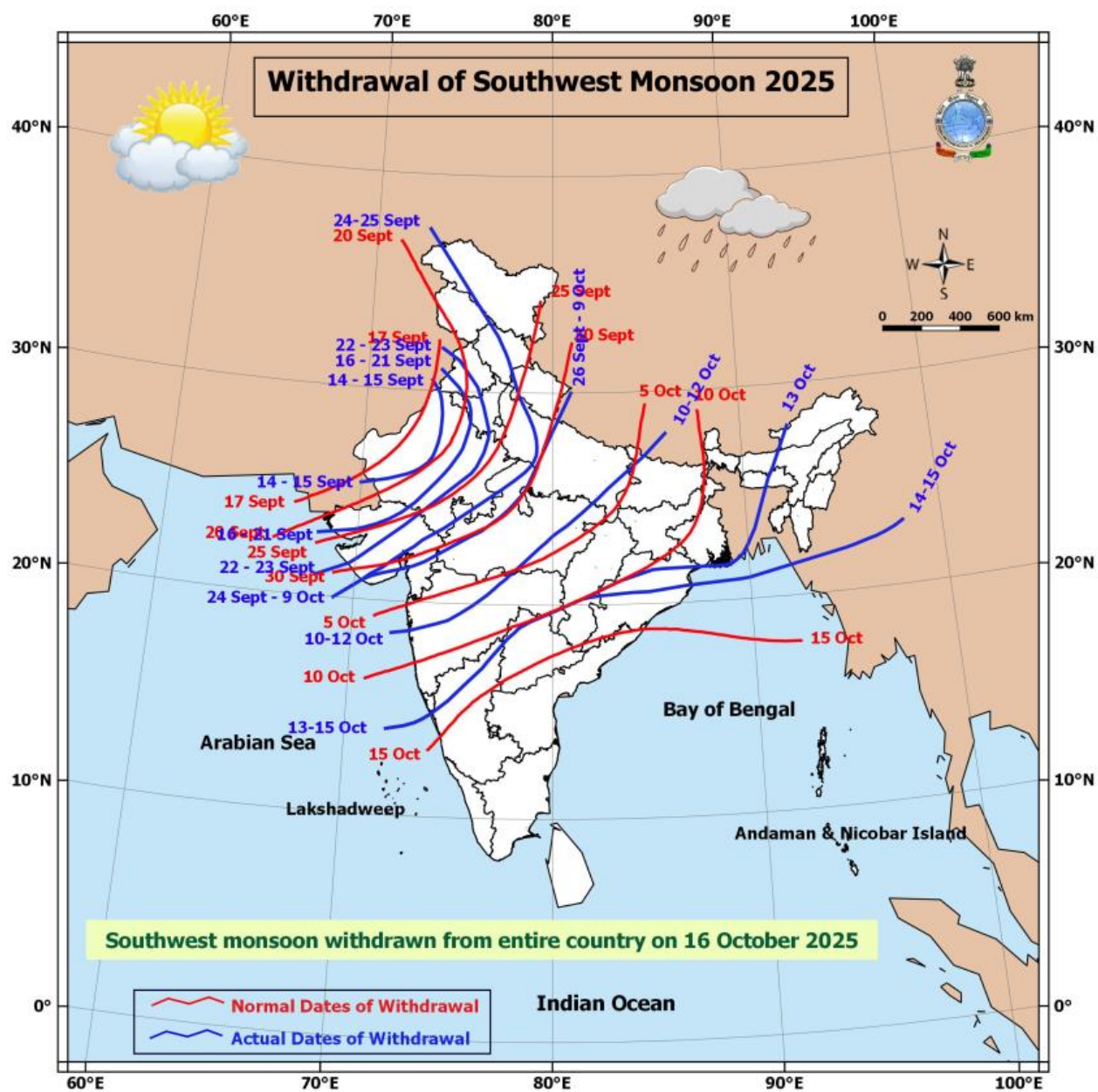
The current storage data for reservoirs across India as of October 9, 2025, reveals a generally healthy water storage status compared to last year and the five-year normal average. Overall, the country’s total live storage stands at 166.7 billion cubic meters (BCM), which is 91.37 percent of total live capacity and represents an 18.54 percent increase over the five-year normal storage of 140.7 BCM. This indicates a strong reservoir filling year, likely reflecting a good monsoon season and improved water availability for irrigation. The western region has the highest reservoir utilization at 97.9 percent of live capacity, with Gujarat and Maharashtra maintaining robust storage levels, 32.9 percent and 14.6 percent above normal, respectively. This suggests excellent water availability in these water-stressed states. Out of 161 reservoirs, 156 reservoirs reported more than 80 percent of normal storage and five reservoirs reported 80 percent or below of normal storage.

Figure 3. Reservoir Storage Status as on October 9, 2025



Source: Central Water Commission, Ministry of Jal Shakti

Figure 4. Withdrawal Dates of Southwest Monsoon 2025



Source: Indian Meteorological Department

Attachments:

No Attachments.